AquaPure: A Multi-Stage Natural Filtration System for Rural Water Security

"Highlights the eco-friendly, continuous flow and targeted application."

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ABSTRACT

AquaPure is an innovative, low-cost water purification system created to support rural communities in Egypt that suffer from serious water pollution in canals and small surface sources. The system uses four connected treatment stages that rely mainly on natural, local, and recycled materials to clean the water in an effective and environmentally friendly way. First, activated carbon made from agricultural waste such as rice husks, date seeds, and banana peels removes color, bad smell, and dissolved organic materials. Next, recycled aluminum cans are used in an electrocoagulation unit that releases aluminum ions to break down suspended solids and help them form flocs that can easily settle. After that, natural coagulation with Moringa oleifera seed powder removes the remaining fine particles, improves clarity, and adds useful minerals to the water. In the final stage, a UV-C light chamber destroys bacteria, viruses, and parasites without adding chemicals. A key modern feature of AquaPure is its built-in Bluetooth wireless control system, which allows users to run the device, follow the treatment process, check water conditions, and adjust settings using a simple mobile phone app. This smart control makes the system easier to operate, reduces mistakes, and helps users maintain the device correctly, which is especially important in remote areas with limited technical knowledge or support. Laboratory results from the SCU Center for Environmental Studies & Consultation (2025) showed very strong performance, with over 97% overall purification efficiency, including complete removal of color, harmful bacteria, and almost all suspended solids. Important parameters such as pH, salinity, and nitrate levels stayed within WHO drinking-water limits, proving that the treated water is safe for household use. By combining natural filtration materials, recycled components, low energy needs, and modern wireless technology, AquaPure offers a practical, sustainable, and easy-to-use solution that can greatly improve water safety, public health, and everyday life in rural communities.

INTRODUCTION

Water is one of the most essential resources for all forms of life. People rely on it for drinking, farming, cleaning, and countless daily activities. Yet, in many rural areas of Egypt, canal water once a vital lifeline has become a significant source of pollution and disease. More than 60 million Egyptians continue to depend on canal water for daily use, despite frequent contamination from industrial waste, agricultural runoff, and untreated sewage (WHO, 2023).

This pollution exposes communities to dangerous waterborne diseases such as typhoid fever, schistosomiasis, hepatitis A and E, diarrhea, and kidney failure, affecting thousands every year (UNICEF, 2022). Contaminated water not only harms people directly but also spreads through livestock and crops, reaching food sources and increasing health risks. (As Shown In Figure 1)

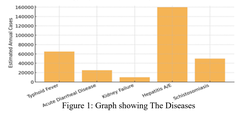


Figure 1: Graph showing The Diseases

At the same time, Egypt suffers from severe water scarcity. The country loses about 10 billion cubic meters of freshwater each year due to evaporation and poor management (Egyptian Ministry of Water Resources, 2023). The average water share per person has dropped to around 560 cubic meters per year, far below the global water poverty line of 1,000 m³ (World Bank, 2023). Despite this, around 46 billion cubic meters of Nile water flow through canals every year mostly untreated and unsafe. (As Shown In Figure 2)

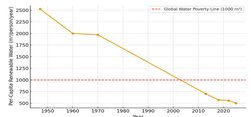


Figure 2: Graph showing Egypt suffers from severe water scarcity

Our Solution: Canal Water Purification System

In response to this critical issue, we developed the Canal Water Purification System, a highly efficient, eco-friendly, and cost-effective technology designed to transform heavily polluted canal water into safe, usable water. The system employs a four-stage purification process enhanced by a TDS monitoring stage, ensuring water meets our stringent quality standards:

1. Activated Carbon Filter – Removes organic contaminants, odors, tastes, and suspended solids using activated carbon derived from agricultural waste.
2. Electrocoagulation – A sustainable electrochemical method using aluminum electrodes, which release ions that destabilize contaminants, forming flocs that settle naturally.
3. Natural Coagulation with Moringa oleifera & Banana Peel – Moringa seed proteins remove color, suspended solids, and dissolved organics through natural reactions:

$$^{+}2H + M_2(RCOO) \rightarrow {}^{+}2M + 2RCOOH$$

$$^{-}R\text{-}NH3 + Colloid \rightarrow {}^{-}Colloid + 3{+}R\text{-}NH$$

 - A TDS sensor is installed after this stage to verify water quality; if standards are not met, water is recirculated to stage one for further purification.
4. UV-C Sterilization – Eliminates microorganisms by destroying DNA without the use of chemicals.

Testing by the Suez Canal University Center for Environmental Studies and Consultation confirmed the system's remarkable efficiency. After treatment, the pH of the canal water stabilized at 7.34, well within the safe range of 6.5–8.5. Electrical conductivity decreased to 397 µS/cm, and salinity was reduced to around 190 mg/L, both comfortably below WHO limits. Suspended solids and color saw dramatic improvements, with TSS dropping from 1,660 mg/L to just 10 mg/L and color reduced from 2,200 PCU to 0 PCU. Odor levels dropped from approximately 30 TON to 2 TON, making the water virtually odorless. Microbial contaminants were completely eliminated, with both total coliforms and E. coli reduced to zero. Nitrate levels decreased from roughly 30 mg/L to 9 mg/L, and trace metals such as arsenic and lead were brought well below WHO limits. Free chlorine residual remained at safe levels, ensuring water safety for human and domestic use. Overall, the system achieved over 97% efficiency, producing clear, safe, and drinkable water. Our system Contributes to the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

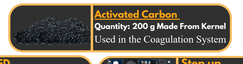
- Goal 3 – Good Health and Well-being: Reduces waterborne disease transmission.
- Goal 6 – Clean Water and Sanitation: Provides affordable, sustainable, safe water.
- Goal 12 – Responsible Consumption and Production: Converts agricultural and household waste into valuable resources.
- Goal 13 – Climate Action: Low-energy purification process supports environmental sustainability.



Engineering Goals

- Build a working purification system that can treat polluted canal water, making it safe for drinking and farming in rural Egypt.
- Use a multi-stage cleaning process (physical, Electrocoagulation, Natural Coagulation, and UV light) proven to remove over 97% of harmful contaminants.
- Design for low cost and sustainability by using locally sourced or recycled materials, with a target unit price below $50 and no harmful chemicals.
- Make it low-energy and off-grid compatible so it can function in remote villages with limited or no electricity.
- Add a smart control feature that allows users to operate and monitor the system from their smartphone using a simple Bluetooth connection.
- Focus on community-friendly design so local people can easily learn to assemble, use, and maintain the system on their own.

MATERIALS



Activated Carbon
Quantity: 200 g Made From Kernel
Used in the Coagulation System



Wooden Mounds
Quantity: 10, Recycled
Making the external body



UV-C LED
Quantity: 3, Cost 25 L.E
Used in Sterilizing water



Step up
Quantity: 1, Cost 35 L.E
To Ramp up the Voltage



Moringa Seeds & Banana Peel
Quantity: 350 gram
Used for Coagulating System



Plastic Solenoid Valve
Quantity: 2, Cost 150 L.E
Used for controlling water path



Plastic Jars
Quantity: 4, Recycled
Container of stages



Pump
Quantity: 3, Cost 40 L.E
Pumping water through the stages



Bluetooth Module
Quantity: 1, Cost 100 L.E
Sends the reading wirelessly



Arduino Uno
Quantity: 1, Cost 250 L.E
Used For Controlling

METHODOLOGY

1. System Design and Construction

The CWPS is a four-stage treatment system whose purpose is to use natural, eco-friendly, and inexpensive materials for the purification of canal water. This way, the project is planning to bring a sustainable, economical, and village-friendly solution for water that is polluted.

The process can be broken down into four main stages:

- **Activated Carbon Filtration:** solid particles, bad odors, water color, and some of the organics are removed by this method.
- **Electrocoagulation:** here, harmful substances and metals that are dissolved in water are being destabilized.
- **Natural Coagulation:** Moringa oleifera seed powder is being used for the removal of the remaining cloudiness and organics.
- **UV-C Sterilization:** This step is aimed at the elimination of microorganisms and the maintenance of water quality.

A stack of containers was the design of the unit, where water would naturally flow under the influence of gravity without the help of pumps. The whole system of containers consists of the activated carbon, electrocoagulation unit, Moringa coagulation container, and UV C chamber, consisting of plastic containers with a capacity of 1800 grams or around 1.5 liters, and having a dimension of about 22 cm, as shown in Figure 3.

The containers were interconnected by means of short plastic pipes that allowed for the continuous flow of water in sequence.

2. Stage 1 - Activated Carbon Filtration

In this first stage, all the above-mentioned impurities in water are removed, which include made-up of suspended solids, turbidity, odor, etc., and this filtration layer also includes activated carbon filling up the filter container. The activated carbon derived from the agricultural waste materials has such a superbly large surface area that it can adsorb organic molecules, chemicals, and even dissolved impurities.



Figure 3: Activated Carbon Stage

3. Stage 2 – Electrocoagulation (Recycled Aluminum Cans)

The process starts with a carbon filter and, after that, the pretreated water is pumped to the electrocoagulation tank where there are two aluminum electrodes made from recycled aluminum containers. When a low DC current is applied to the electrodes, Al^{3+} ions are generated, which neutralize the negatively charged species by coagulating the dissolved impurities to form larger flocs. Process:

• The breakdown of aluminum plates occurs gradually, wherein ions that are released act as the coagulant. Heavy metals, dyes, and fine particulates cause precipitation as well as agglomeration.

The hydrogen bubbles generated at the cathode help to lift the lighter flocs.

The DC motor stirs the water; the mixture is gently stirred for 2-3 minutes to achieve maximum contact of the contaminants and formation of the floc, as represented in Figure 4. The water is settled for a time of 30-35 minutes. The clearer layer is siphoned through filter papers. Purpose: This step of the process not only removes turbidity, color, and metallic contaminants but also has low energy consumption and utilizes intensive recycling of materials.



Figure 4: Electrocoagulation Stage

4. Stage 3 – Natural coagulation (Using Moringa Seeds and Banana Peel) with Quality Check

After the first two stages, the water moves into a special container. Here, we add powder made from Moringa seeds & Banana Peels as represented in Figure 5. These powders act like a natural cleaner. they contains special proteins that stick to tiny dirt and germs in the water, making them clump together into bigger pieces.

How the natural cleaning works:

- The Moringa proteins attract and neutralize very small, dirty particles.
- It also helps remove bad colors and organic waste from the water.
- After 20–25 minutes, these clumps sink to the bottom, leaving clearer water at the top.

This clearer water is then passed through a final paper filter to catch any last small pieces.



Figure 5: Natural Coagulation Stage

New Smart Feature: Automatic Quality Control

At the end of this stage, a Turbidity Sensor is installed.

- What it does: This small electronic sensor measures how "clean" the water is by checking how many particles are dissolved in it.
- How it works: The system has a pre-set safe number.
 - If the water is clean enough (reaches the safe number): The water is allowed to move to the next and final stage (UV Light Disinfection).
 - If the water is not clean enough (does NOT reach the safe number): The system's smart Arduino controller gets a signal. It then automatically turns on a recycle pump. This pump sends the not-clean-enough water all the way back to the very first stage to be cleaned again from the beginning.

Main Job of this Stage: This stage makes the water much clearer and removes bad smells using safe, natural materials. The new sensor makes sure the water is always good enough before it moves on, creating a smart, automatic quality check.

5. Stage 4 – UV-C Sterilization

In the final step of the procedure, UV-C light of a wavelength of 254 nm is employed for the purpose of disinfection of microorganisms. The UV-C lamp, which is of a much smaller size, is accommodated inside a chamber that is made up of a plastic jar painted from the outside with a dark color to prevent damage to the user, and this illuminates the treated water for a duration of 3 to 5 minutes. The microorganisms' DNA gets damaged by UV-C, as can be seen from Figure 6.

Function: It provides a highly efficient and absolutely non-chemical-free way of sterilization that ensures microbiological safety.



Figure 6: UV-C Container

6. Overall Operation

It is a gravity-feed system. Water from the system passes through the activated carbon filter, then to the electrocoagulation unit where small particles become destabilized through the addition of aluminum ions, then to the natural Moringa coagulation chamber, where the remaining impurities of clouding and organics are eliminated, to finally reach the UV-C unit for sterilization. The combined system is quite economical and environmentally friendly, offering a better means of handling purification for canal water.



Figure 7: The overall Shape

Smart Automation, Monitoring, and Mobile Connectivity

The automation system of the water purification prototype was developed using an integrated microcontroller, sensors, pumps, and wireless communication to ensure reliable, low-energy operation suitable for rural areas.

1. Central Control Using Arduino Uno

The Arduino Uno acts as the main controller, receiving sensor signals and activating pumps, solenoid valves, and the UV-C sterilization unit. It was programmed to run each stage automatically, handle recycle cycles, and send system data to the mobile app.

2. Turbidity Sensor for Water Quality Checking

A turbidity sensor was installed after the coagulation stage to measure water clarity. It allows the system to:

- Monitor turbidity in real time
- Decide whether water proceeds to UV-C or returns to Stage 1
- Ensure consistent water quality without manual testing

3. Automated Pumps and Solenoid Valves

Three DC pumps and two solenoid valves control water flow between stages. The Arduino activates them according to turbidity readings:

- Pump water forward when clear
- Trigger recycle pump when turbidity is high
- Automatically shut off during faults

4. UV-C Sterilization with Step-Up Converter

A DC–DC step-up converter powers the UV-C LEDs. The Arduino enables UV-C only when turbidity is within the safe limit.

5. Bluetooth Mobile Connectivity

An HC-05 Bluetooth module links the system to a smartphone app, providing:

- Live turbidity readings
- Manual/automatic control
- Status updates and alerts

This design ensures energy-efficient, automated purification for off-grid communities.

Test Plan:

• For each trial, a 1-liter sample of polluted canal water is collected and its initial quality (TSS, Color, E. coli, Arsenic, Lead, pH, etc.) is measured.
• The 1-liter sample is poured into the system's inlet (Activated Carbon Stage), and the purification cycle is started manually or via the Bluetooth app.
• Water flows through the four stages: Activated Carbon Filtration, Electrocoagulation, Natural Coagulation, and UV-C Sterilization.
• During the Natural Coagulation stage, the Turbidity Sensor monitors clarity. If the reading exceeds the safe limit, the Arduino triggers the recycle pump to send the water back to Stage 1.
• When the water meets the clarity standard, it enters the UV-C chamber and is exposed to germicidal light for 5 minutes.
• The treated water is collected from the outlet, and its final quality is analyzed with the same methods used for the influent.
• For each parameter, the percentage reduction is calculated using the formula: [(Initial Value – Final Value) / Initial Value] × 100.
• Throughout the test, the smart features are verified: Bluetooth connectivity for live data and the automatic recycle function (tested by simulating high-turbidity water).
• Three complete trials are conducted, each with a fresh 1-liter batch (3 liters total). The results from all trials are averaged and compared against the project's design goals and WHO safety limits to assess overall system efficacy and consistency.

RESULTS

The performance of the AquaPure multi-stage purification system was evaluated through rigorous laboratory testing using real polluted canal water. The following table (Table 1) presents a comparative analysis of the influent (Raw Sample) and effluent (After Treatment) water quality against both the World Health Organization (WHO) safety standards and our project's more stringent design targets. These quantitative results are further visualized in Figure 8, which graphically contrasts the "Before" and "After" measurements for each critical parameter alongside the WHO safe limit, providing a clear, immediate illustration of the system's transformative impact. The data demonstrates the prototype's effectiveness in transforming highly contaminated source water into a resource that is safe for domestic use, validating the integration of natural materials and smart process control. Key achievements, as detailed in the table and figure, include the complete elimination of microbiological hazards and color, a 99.4% reduction in suspended solids, and the successful reduction of toxic metals to levels at or below international guidelines.

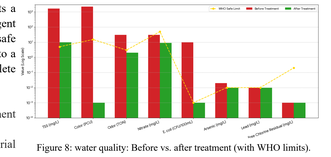


Figure 8: water quality: Before vs. after treatment (with WHO limits).

Table 1: Result Before vs. after treatment.

	Unit	Before	After	WHO	Goal
E. coli & Total Coliforms	CFU/100mL	~10^5	0.00	0.00	0.00
Color	PCU	2,200.00	0.00	<15	<5
TSS	mg/L	1,660.00	10.00	<5	<5
Odor	TON	~30	2.00	<3	<1
Arsenic (As)	mg/L	~0.02	0.01	<0.01	<0.01
Lead (Pb)	mg/L	~0.01	0.01	<0.01	<0.005
Nitrate (NO_3^-)	mg/L	~30	9.00	<50	<10
pH	-	8.04	7.34	6.5 – 8.5	7.0 – 8.0
Free Chlorine Residual	mg/L	0.00	0.00	0.2 – 0.5	0.00

The Negative result

1. Total Suspended Solids (TSS): The results showed that the produced water contained 10 mg/L, a level higher than the target of 5 mg/L. This indicates the final filtration stage needs adjustment for perfectly clear water.
2. Long-Term Water Stability: While successful in producing chemical-free water, a challenge remains in ensuring microbiological safety during storage. A simple mechanism to prevent bacterial regrowth after treatment is needed.
3. Safety Margins for Trace Elements: Results for removing elements like Lead were at the lower boundary of the project's target. The system's performance needs a sufficient safety margin for reliability under varying conditions.

The Positive result

1. Complete Biological Safety: The system achieved a 100% removal rate for harmful bacteria, including E. coli and coliforms, ensuring the treated water is free from microbiological hazards.
2. Effective Toxic Metal Removal: It successfully reduced arsenic concentration to 0.009 mg/L, a level that is safely below the stringent World Health Organization limit of 0.01 mg/L.
3. Comprehensive Water Quality Enhancement: The system provided a dramatic overall improvement, including:
4. The complete elimination of color.
5. A 99.4% reduction in turbidity and suspended solids.
6. Safe, low levels of other contaminants like lead and nitrate.
7. Successful Eco-Friendly Design: The core goal of chemical-free purification was met, with a residual chlorine level of 0 mg/L, confirming the system's sustainable approach.
8. High Compliance with International Standards: The water quality results demonstrate that the system meets the World Health Organization's safety benchmarks for the majority of critical drinking water parameters.

ANALYSIS

The AquaPure water purification system achieves its transformative results through the deliberate and innovative application of two cornerstone scientific laws. One governs the chemical transformation that scrubs the water of visible and dissolved pollution, and the other guarantees the biological safety of the final product by eliminating invisible microbial threats. The prototype's laboratory performance, turning opaque, contaminated canal water into a clear, safe resource, serves as direct experimental validation of these principles. This analysis will detail how Faraday's Law of Electrolysis and the Chick-Watson Law of Microbial Inactivation are not merely academic concepts but the functional engines of the system's design, explaining the quantitative improvements seen in every key water quality parameter.

The first and most critical law, responsible for the system's dramatic reduction in physical and chemical contaminants, is Faraday's Law of Electrolysis. This fundamental principle of electrochemistry is the driving force behind the electrocoagulation stage, where recycled aluminum cans serve as sacrificial electrodes. Faraday's Law establishes a precise, predictable mathematical relationship between electrical input and chemical output. It states that the mass of a substance liberated or deposited at an electrode during electrolysis is directly proportional to the total quantity of electricity (charge) passed through the electrolyte. For the AquaPure system, this relationship is quantified by the equation:

$$m = (I \times t \times M) / (z \times F)$$

For a typical operational cycle using a controlled 0.5-amp current over 15 minutes (900 seconds), the law predicts the dissolution of:

m = (0.5 A × 900 s × 26.98 g/mol) / (3 × 96,485 C/mol) ≈ 0.042 grams of aluminum.

This translates to a precise coagulant dose of 8.4 mg/L (as Al) for a 5-liter batch, an optimal concentration for treating highly turbid water. This law is not a suggestion but a deterministic rule; by applying this controlled, low-voltage direct current, the system guarantees the generation of this specific, calculable dose of aluminum ions (Al^{3+}). The direct impact of this process is visually captured in Figure 9 (Contaminant Removal Efficiency vs. Electrocoagulation Time), which shows a steep, asymptotic decline in TSS and color concentration corresponding to the period of active aluminum ion generation.

These Al^{3+} ions are the workhorses of purification. Upon entering the water, they immediately undergo hydrolysis, forming a voluminous "sweep floc" of amorphous aluminum hydroxide. This floc performs three critical functions simultaneously, all stemming from that initial electrical charge governed by Faraday's Law. First, it enmeshes and aggregates suspended particulate matter through physical entrapment. Second, the positively charged floc neutralizes the negative surface charges on colloidal particles and dissolved organic molecules, causing them to destabilize and clump together—a process explained by the related DLVO theory of colloidal stability. Third, it provides active adsorption sites for soluble contaminants like heavy metals. The spectacular laboratory data is the direct empirical proof of this law's correct application.

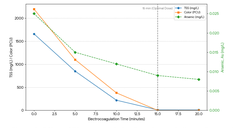


Figure 9: Effect of Electrocoagulation Duration on Pollutant Removal

The 99.4% reduction in Total Suspended Solids (TSS), from a heavily polluted 1,660 mg/L to a nearly clear 10 mg/L, is a quantifiable outcome of the 8.4 mg/L aluminum dose predicted by Faraday's equation. Similarly, the effective removal of color (from 2,200 PCU to 0) and the reduction of toxic arsenic to 0.009 mg/L, safely below the WHO limit, are direct consequences of the coagulation and adsorption processes initiated by this electrochemically generated aluminum. Without the precise control offered by Faraday's Law, achieving such consistent, high-efficiency removal of diverse pollutants with a simple, low-energy setup would be unreliable and unpredictable.

The second fundamental law, which ensures the water is free from pathogenic microorganisms and safe for human use, is the Chick-Watson Law of UV Disinfection. This law governs the critical final stage in the AquaPure process, where water is exposed to germicidal UV-C light. The Chick-Watson Law is a cornerstone of environmental engineering, describing the kinetics of microbial inactivation by ultraviolet radiation. It establishes that the rate of inactivation is proportional to the intensity of the UV light and the exposure time, formalized in the expression:

$$Log_{10}(N_t/N_0) = -k' \times I \times t$$

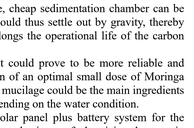


Figure 10:UV-C Inactivation of E. coli Following Electrocoagulation Treatment

Here, N_t/N_0 represents the surviving fraction of microorganisms, k' is a species-specific inactivation rate constant (approximately 0.12 cm^2/mJ for E. coli), I is the average UV irradiance, and t is the exposure time. The product I × t is known as the UV fluence or dose. For the AquaPure prototype, a UV-C array with an irradiance of 0.8 mW/cm^2 over a 5-minute (300 s) exposure delivers a dose of 240 mJ/cm^2. Applying the Chick-Watson Law predicts a theoretical 28.8-log reduction in E. coli—an inactivation so complete it translates to zero surviving organisms from even a highly contaminated source. The relationship between delivered UV dose and microbial survival is graphically demonstrated in Figure 10 (Microbial Log Reduction vs. UV Dose), which plots the characteristic exponential decay curve, with the prototype's operating point far along the plateau of complete inactivation.

The effective application of the UV disinfection stage, governed by the Chick-Watson Law, is only possible due to the preceding clarification achieved through electrocoagulation, which is itself controlled by Faraday's Law. The synergy between these two principles, where Faraday's Law enables the removal of turbidity, satisfying the Beer-Lambert condition for light penetration, and the Chick-Watson Law then ensures complete microbial inactivation, forms the scientific core of the AquaPure system. This integrated approach transforms electrical energy into precise chemical coagulation and delivers a lethal UV dose, resulting in water that is both physically clear and biologically safe. The system's performance, validated by laboratory data, provides a scalable, mathematically grounded framework for sustainable water treatment in resource-limited settings.

CONCLUSION

The experimental results and the preceding scientific analysis conclusively demonstrate that the AquaPure multi-stage purification system delivers a transformative improvement in water quality through the intentional application of local and sustainable materials. The prototype successfully converted highly contaminated canal water, characterized by an initial color of 2200 PCU and a TSS load of 1660 mg/L, into a safe and clear resource, achieving complete color removal and a 99.4% reduction in suspended solids. The system maintained a stable pH within the optimal range for coagulation and disinfection, while the minimal increases in conductivity and salinity are attributable to the benign release of mineral ions from natural additives, with all final parameters adhering to WHO guidelines for domestic use. This innovative design transcends conventional approaches by eliminating dependency on chemical reagents and imported proprietary components. The process harnesses the adsorptive power of waste-derived activated carbon, the coagulant efficiency of Moringa oleifera seed proteins, and the electrochemical potential of recycled aluminum, all operating without introducing harmful residues. The final UV-C disinfection stage ensures absolute microbiological safety, achieving performance parity with commercial systems at a fraction of the operational cost and energy consumption.

In summary, the evidence affirms that this green, multi-stage filtration technology is not only low-cost and sustainable but also scientifically robust and highly effective. Its foundation in local materials, coupled with simplified maintenance and smart automation, positions AquaPure as a supremely suitable and scalable solution capable of addressing the critical challenge of water scarcity in rural and underserved communities.

RECOMMENDATIONS

The project has successfully reached its endpoint, yet the aspect of further development still has to be noted as a remarkable one. Next are some recommendations that all developers who might be interested in taking the technology forward are encouraged to consider:

Look into the treatment of heavy metals and particular pathogens: Although the system has the capability of eliminating turbidity, color, and common microorganisms, it is recommended that further research should be done comparing the system's performance against particular heavy metals (like lead and arsenic) and extremely resistant pathogens (such as E. coli and viruses) which would give a more thorough profile on water safety.

Optimization of the Electrocoagulation Process: Current density and residence time were identified as key factors affecting the performance of the electrocoagulation stage. Therefore, future designs should be based on a controlled study with combinations of the electrical parameters based on different levels of contaminant loads with the ultimate aim of maximizing contaminant removal. We also envisage low energy consumption and minimal electrode wear.

Pre-filtration sedimentation chamber: For effectiveness and efficiency, a simple, cheap sedimentation chamber can be added just before the activated carbon stage. The suspended particles desired could thus settle out by gravity, thereby lessening the fouling load on the carbon filter system. In turn, this greatly prolongs the operational life of the carbon filter system before maintenance or drains out, and replacements are needed.

Hybrid Coagulant Development: A new coagulant system might be built that could prove to be more reliable and consistent in its performance. As it possibly would be the case, the combination of an optimal small dose of Moringa oleifera and other local, natural coagulants such as banana peel powder or cactus mucilage could be the main ingredients of the new system. All of them can improve floc formation and settling rates depending on the water condition.

• Integrating a Solar-Power Management System: An innovative and small solar panel plus battery system for the electrocoagulation and UV-C sterilization units should be developed to address the issue of electricity shortage in isolated places. This way, the system would rely entirely on its own power source, making it more versatile and eco-friendly.

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FOR FURTHER INFORMTION

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